

DatUnlimited Manifesto

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2nd Edition (authored by Nathan Zak, edited with Mohana Vegesna)

Mission Statement:

We exist as a group of like-minded students of CS361 who strive to meet deadlines early and to bring our data-based microservices to market via Web Apps. We show up with a positive attitude and maintain hope when overcoming the inevitable barriers that we'll face—both individually, and together.

Ground Rules:

1. Vision:

a. We will create microservices based around gathering, analyzing, and using data to achieve greater purposes in higher level services.

2. Priorities:

a. We prioritize our work and aim to begin work on projects as soon as they're available to us, within reason, outside obligations permitting.

b. We aim to meet deadlines before they're due (approx. 2-3 days before the turn-in date) to allow more time for troubleshooting and unseen interruptions in the project schedule.

3. Communication:

a. We will communicate primarily on Microsoft Teams in our DatUnlimited group chat.

b. Each member is responsible for enabling their notifications and participating in the chat in an honest, genuine, and gently earnest fashion.

4. Conflict:

a. When a team member identifies a conflict:

1. We will step away from our normal communication/work schedule to directly focus on solving the conflict. The member who brings the issue to the group will create a dedicated discussion on Canvas within the DatUnlimited group, the title being: "[Conflict] ... ", with the ellipses being replaced with the subject matter.
2. Each member will state their case and position on the conflict in a couple short paragraphs (~250 words or less)
3. We will all respond to each member's responses, and after everyone has responded
4. We will all propose a solution, considering what the others have said and trying our best to all come up with a solution that seems logically best or at least compromises in a way that benefits all members
5. We will cast a vote on our preferred solution (which may or may not be our own)
6. If the votes are unanimous, the solution is now identified, chosen, and agreed upon by all members.

***If a singular solution is not identified, repeat steps 2-5 until one is found.*

b. If a solution is not found after 3 rounds of voting, the professor will be consulted for the best path forward.

5. Work Habits:

a. We aim to keep pace ahead of the class schedule as much as feasibly possible.

b. We will check in with the group chat 1-2 times a week minimum to make sure we stay engaged and afloat to the conversation, as well as on top of upcoming assignments.

6. Responsiveness:

a. It is each member's goal to respond to messages directly involving them within 24 hours, if possible, of receiving the message.

b. The group may use the dedicated Discord server and each member's personal OSU email to attempt to reach the unresponsive team member.

7. Failure:

- a. If a group member has been unresponsive to direct messages for more than 3 days, the other group members reserve the right to move on without them when it comes to group decisions.
- b. If a group member is absent from the group chat for a week or more, and has not responded to messages in MS Teams, Discord, or via OSU email, the other group members reserve the right to reach out to the professor in an attempt to reach the other member, or to come up with a plan on how to move forward with less members, for at least the specific assignment at hand (and possible future ones as well).

8. Camaraderie:

- a. We will take turns coming up with one question per week to ask the group to get to know each other better. These questions don't need to be deep, and the responses don't need to be long, but they will undoubtedly shed insight into each other's personalities in ways that will help us problem solve and work as a unit.
- b. This conversation for team building will take place on the dedicated DatUnlimited Discord server.

***Example questions: What is your favorite color? Hobby? Do you speak any other languages? What got you into CS? etc.*